

anyone with a passion to learn could start coding and experimenting, and that's really where almost all the technology innovation of the past 25 years stems from.

What the PC also did was topple a few big names in the technology world. IBM, despite being the ones who started the disruption themselves, almost got wiped out. In order to quickly come to market and crush the new upstart of a company (Apple), IBM threw together its IBM PC based on mostly existing electronics, which were more importantly, unpatentable. Although it did succeed in ensuring that Apple never really took the world by storm with its MAC hardware and software, IBM opened the floodgates to PC clones, and the price war that followed. The consumer won in the end, but some companies such as IBM and Apple were left with ruined business models. It wouldn't be until more than a decade later that Apple would finally recover, and some would say IBM never really did (certainly not in the consumer space).

THE WEB IS CAST

The "internet" is something that happened in the lifetime of most of you reading this article. However, the idea of connecting people across distances to enable them to communicate probably goes even further back than carrier pigeons! Instantaneous communication probably dates back to the telegram days, and so on.

The first big development to take place was the idea of networking computers across large geographical areas. Then what followed was finding out that not all computers were able to understand one another, because they didn't speak the same language. This is when Vinton Cerf was recruited by DARPA to come up with a networking protocol that all computers could use to communicate with. It was

1973. Cerf had already developed the NCP (Network Control Program) protocol that DARPA's computers used to communicate with one another – that network was called the ARPANet. This is how TCP/IP was conceived. Finally, new year's day, in 1983, the whole ARPANet was rebooted to switch from NCP to TCP/IP. After a public briefing about TCP/IP by DARPA, the commercial world took to TCP/IP en masse, and this is how just anyone could connect to the Internet.



The first ever ARPANet router

However, the real power of the internet was finally released by another disruption. The World Wide Web, as designed by Sir Timothy Berners-Lee, is what sparked the idea of using a web server, and a browser to access the said server. It also brought URIs (Unique Resource Identifiers) which made it easier to find things.

In 1991, at CERN, the first website went live. The first webpage was: <http://info.cern.ch/hypertext/WWW/TheProject.html>.

Berners-Lee also coded the first browser, to be able to access the first web page. Then Marc Andreessen developed Mosaic (which was to later become Netscape Navigator) in 1993, which was the first browser capable of displaying images alongside text, which meant even non-computer-savvy people could look at a web page and understand it... and then the internet went BOOM!

MR. KNOW IT ALL!

What happens when the web starts reaching everyone? Information starts getting shared, and soon enough you need to find a way to find the right information. That's when search engines are born, and many were born before Google came along. Search engines would display links for a search keyword based on how many times the keyword appeared in the specified web page. They then ranked the pages, and displayed them accordingly. Of course there was more complex math than just that happening, but it's a simplified explanation we're after. When Sergey Brin and Larry Page were studying together in Stanford, they started talking about how they could do better than what existing search engines were doing. Instead of basing things just on keywords, they could add complexity and also check how many sites linked to the page in question, and how reliable those sites were. Today, we know that to be their PageRank algorithm, and millions have tried to get the better of it, to game the system, and very few succeed for very little time.

Brin and Page incorporated Google in 1998, almost sold it in 1999 for under \$1 million (because they felt it was interfering with their studies), and then later the same year they got investors to pump in \$25 million. They took over the internet, and then went public in 2004. Today

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